

Unit 1



Fundamentals of Geography

Chapter Outline

1.1 Introduction
1.2 Defining Geography
1.3 Evolution of Geography
1.4 Themes of Geography
1.5 Geography's Relation with Physical and Social Science Disciplines
1.6 Approaches to the study of Geography
1.7 Branches of Geography
1.8 Geographical Tools and Skills
1.9 Geography in Tamil Nadu
1.10 Databases for Geography Teaching and Learning

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Learning Objectives:

- *Define the concept of geography*
- *Appreciate the developments of geography*
- *Understand the traditions and themes of geography*
- *Associate the relationship of geography with other disciplines*
- *Identify the approaches to study geography*
- *Examine various branches of geography*
- *Appreciate the tools, skills and scopes of geography*

1.1 Introduction

"The study of Geography is about more than just memorising places on a map. It is about understanding the complexity of our world, appreciating the diversity of cultures that exists across continents. And in the end it is about using all that knowledge to help bridge divides and bring people together" - Barak Obama, Former President of USA.

The subject 'Geography' is considered as 'The Mother of all Sciences' as most streams of sciences took root from geography. It is a subject much needed in everyday life. Just as an intellectual understands the value of a library, a financier understands the value of money, a parent understands the value of their child a geographer understands the value of our planet earth and the wealth of resources it offers to us.

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